Reading Detective: practice paper

First, learn the question words. Then read the story and answer the questions. **Find the line before you write.**

Question words

If the question says…	…your answer must	Start like this
impression	What you think a character is **like**: a describing word (curious, brave…) plus proof.	She seems ___ because ___.
suggest / suggests	Read between the lines: what does it show **that the text doesn't say straight out**?	This suggests that ___.
evidence	A quote or detail **from the text** that proves your point. Not your own idea.	…because it says "___".
atmosphere	The **feeling or mood** of a place or scene (mysterious, tense, cheerful, spooky).	The writer makes it feel ___ by ___.
effect	What something **did to** a character or the reader: made them jump, feel calm, laugh.	It made them ___.
explain	Say **why or how**, not just what. Use *because*.	___ because ___.
give two ways	Two **different** clues. The same clue twice in new words only scores once.	1. ___ 2. (a different clue) ___
find and copy	Copy the **exact word(s)** from the text. Only what is asked: one word means one word.	(the word, spelt as in the text)
according to the text	Answer **only** from what the text says, even if you know more.	The text says ___.
summary / summarise	The **main idea of the whole text**, not one detail from it.	It is mostly about ___.
predict / most likely to happen next	Use **clues in the text** to say what will happen next, and say which clue.	I think ___ because ___.

Read: The Storm Shed

Nobody used the old shed at the bottom of Mrs Patel's garden. Its door hung crooked, and ivy had crept across the only window like a hand.

On Tuesday, Isla and her little brother Ben were sent to fetch the deckchairs. Ben stopped at the gate. "I'll wait here," he said, kicking at the gravel.

Isla rolled her eyes and marched on. The door groaned as she pulled it. Inside, the air was cold and smelled of old rain. Something ticked in the darkness: slowly, steadily, like a clock that had been waiting.

She held her breath. The ticking stopped.

"Isla?" Ben's voice floated down the path. "Did you find them?"

She looked at the dusty deckchairs, then at the shadowy corner where the sound had been. "Yes," she called back. "Coming." But she didn't move. Not yet.

The Storm Shed: questions

1 Find and **copy** one word that shows the shed door was hard to open. 1 mark

2 How can you tell Ben did **not** want to go near the shed? Give **two** ways. 2 marks

3 What **impressions** do you get of Isla? Give two impressions, using **evidence** from the text. 3 marks

4 How does the writer create a **mysterious atmosphere**? Give two ways, using evidence from the text. 3 marks

5 What do you **predict** Isla will do next? Use the text to explain why. 2 marks

6 *…ivy had crept across the only window like a hand.* What does this **suggest** about the shed? 1 mark

Check before you finish: □ two *different* points where it says two □ each answer proves the question's key word □ impressions = describing word + proof □ every answer came from a line in the story.